

The Grandfather Tree

32. Large Room.

This immense empty room disappears into the gloom all around the adventurers. The roof is a mortised stone cathedraled roof that is 20' high. Several rusting iron chandeliers hang from the roof on iron chains. Resting in some of the chandeliers is the remains of candles and torches. The room is coated in dust and cobwebs with the exception for an intricate mosaic pattern on the floor of a giant, 45' long, twin-headed banded serpent with hooded heads like a cobra, curled in a striking position.

Entering the room will cause the giant serpent to appear from the Astral plane and it will immediately ask the adventurers why they are disturbing its sleep and then will ask them a riddle in order for them to cross the room safely.

The riddle asked is:

“A few have two, and many none,
A few have eight, but none have one,
The most have six, and lots have four,
A few have many, many more.”²⁶

The answer is “legs” and when spoken, the snake will return to the Astral plane with a sighing whisper. Should the adventurers take a long time answering, then the snake will begin to hiss and urge them to answer quickly. Should they reduce the snake to 0 hp, it disappears to the Astral plane to heal and will not bother the adventurers again.

Twin-Headed Snake: INT 15; AL CN; AC 4; HD 9; hp 72; THACO 11; #AT 2; Dmg 4d4/4d4 and breath weapons or spells; SA left head breath weapon is a cone of fire that does 6d8 points of damage, save versus breath weapon for half damage, right head is a spitting serpent that will cause blindness as the spell unless a successful save versus poison is made for 1d6 rounds, and does 2d4 points of damage, all equipment must save versus acid; spells: *hypnotic spray*, *suggestion*, *shield*, *ESP*, *sleep*, *slow*, *haste* and *color spray*; SD immune to fire based attacks, half damage from electrical attacks and blunt attacks; MR 89%; SZ H; ML 15.²⁷

On the West wall are two secret doors, while the North wall bears one. All are untrapped and can be opened easily with a successful detection roll.

33. Cloak Room.

The walls of this room are ringed with head-high bronze hooks. This room still smells of damp wool.

34. Really Big Empty Room.

This absolutely huge room is empty and bare of furniture. Tiled in a fine rose marble, its walls painted in faded frescos it was meant to impress the visitor.

35. Room.

This 10' wide and 30' long room appears empty and bare. The room is littered with cobwebs and a thick layer of dust.

Sitting in the center of this room, on the Astral plane is a small brass box. Only by casting *plane shift* or using other magic to see creatures on other planes, the adventurers will probably never discover the box.

The box is unlocked but is trapped with two magical spells. The first trap is a *trap the soul* spell cast at 21st-level that will effect the first character touching the box. The second spell also cast at 21st-level is a *vampiric touch* that will remove 2d4 levels from the second adventure to touch the box.

Opening the box reveals it to contain four sheets of hammered gold bearing curious runes and sigils for spells of the like never seen before. After translation, which will take 1d8 weeks, the plates are discovered to be four of the legendary Nether Scrolls²⁸, and contain the spells: *teleport beacon*²⁹, *electric bow*³⁰, *Flamsterd's flamestrke*³¹, and *lesser spelldream*³².

36. Trapped Secret Room.

This secret bears two mechanical traps. The first releases blinding cloud that will blind 2d4 rounds unless a successful save versus poison is made. The second trap releases a poisonous cloud that will effect everyone within 10' of the door, causing immediate death or 30 hp of damage if a successful save versus poison is made.

The small dark and damp room is empty save for a small rotting; banded, wooden barrel and a large rolled up red rug that seems in perfect condition. The barrel is filled with rotting sawdust through which worms and beetles crawl. Sifting through the sawdust will reveal several cut fire sapphires (worth 5,600 gp total). Unrolling the rug reveals it to be in immaculate condition and has pictures of birds of prey flying on it. The rug is a large *carpet of*

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*flying*³³ that will *fly* as the spell when the command word “whisk” is spoken. The rest of the controls are at the rider’s mental wishes. However, the command word must be spoken by screaming it at the top of the lungs.

37. Another Trapped Secret Room.

The door to this room bears two mechanical and magical traps. The first is a blinding gas cloud trap that will effect everyone within 10’ of the door. A successful save versus poison will negate its effects; otherwise, the characters will be blinded for 3d6 rounds. The second trap is a rain of poisonous darts from the roof that will strike all characters within 5’ of the door. The darts do 4d4; in addition, a save versus poison must be made or the character dies immediately. A successful save still means the character suffers 30 hp of damage.

Stepping into this secret room reveals another dark passageway about 20’ long of with a 10’ high ceiling that ends in another small room. The walls and roof are made of mortised stone. Along the walls are several empty bronze torch scones spaced evenly every 10’ about 5’ high. About halfway down the passage is a small keyhole spaced evenly between the floor, roof and ceiling.

Any thief that makes a successful pick locks and Intelligence roll can make this “lock” function. However, it only seems to make a clanking noise behind the walls. What the lock actually does is shut off the trap in the following room when the lock is turned to the left.

The room at the end of the passageway is about 20’ wide and 50’ long and is dimly lit by four bronze lamp holders that support small glass globes of shining light. The lamp holders are set on either side of the entrance. The only other item in the room is a simple wooden pegboard on the far wall. There are nine wooden pegs on it, but only the first peg holds a small leather bag.

When something passes between the lights, a barrage of barbed darts is released from the opposite wall to strike the characters. Damage done is 3d4+2.

Any thief checking the pegboard for traps has a -35% chance of detecting and disarming the traps on the board. The third peg on the board is trapped causing the roof to open, dumping 64 boulders into the room doing 10d8 points damage. The fifth peg on the board when pulled will cause a long narrow panel to open in the floor revealing a nine-foot long spear with a steel, spade-shaped point. The spear is a *spear* +3, *returning*, and +4 *versus all dragons*.

38. The Final Trapped Secret Room.

The door to this room is trapped with a poisonous gas cloud that will effect everyone within 10’ of the door causing 1d8 points of damage or, with a successful save versus poison, no damage.

Opening this door reveals another dark 20’ long passageway that ends in a large dark room. Both the room and the passage are made of mortised stone and have ceilings 10’ high. The room is about 20’ wide and 30’ long. The room and passage are covered in a thick layer of dust and cobwebs. In the center of the room is a large rotting wooden table that is littered with numerous bottles and jars, some of which are broken and have spilled their contents upon the table and floor.

Carefully searching the table for a minimum of four rounds will reveal four useable potions. The first is a *potion of flight* that will allow the drinker to *fly* as the spell for 3d4 rounds. The second potion is a *protection from normal missiles* that will protect the drinker for 1d4 rounds. The third potion is a *protection from normal undead* that will function for 2d4 rounds. The last potion is a *phase potion*³⁴.

39. Secret Passageway.

This passage has a ceiling 12’ high and is 10’ wide and 20’ long but ends in a plain stone dead end. There is nothing of interest in the room but the dead end that has a *glyph of warding* with a *slay living* spell cast upon it. The first character to touch the door must save versus death magic or fall dead. A successful save means that the character suffers 30 hp of damage.

40. Secret Passageway.

This passage has a ceiling 12’ high and is 10’ wide and 20’ long but ends in a plain stone dead end.

There are four trip wires spaced evenly in the passage that will drop two pots of lamp oil and then a Greek fire pot. Damage done from each trap is 2d8+4 points. The deadened is warded by a *glyph of warding* that holds a *trap the soul* spell that will effect the first character touching the door. A successful save versus spells will allow the character to avoid the trap.

41. The Race Creator Room.

This immense room is 160’ wide by 110’ long and has a roof 30’ high. The room is brightly lit by several magical lamps. There is a gigantic winged bear with rams horns protruding from its forehead and eagle talons for claws sitting over a large pile of treasure on a stone dais in the center of a bubbling pool of liquid that gives off foul smelling vapors. The dais is 30’ wide and 20’ long. The pool is shaped in a half circle and starts at the back wall and enters the room in a 90’ half-moon shape. Standing directly to the right and left of the door in front of the pool are two, large, stone statues shaped like giant lizards. These statues are beginning to move towards the door. A large

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circular plaque of concentric circles dominates the rear wall of the room with a black dot in the center.

The pool of acid will cause 2d4 points damage should the characters fall into it.

Stone Golem (2): INT 0; AL N; AC 5; MV 6; HD 14; hp 112; THACO 7; #AT 1; Dmg 3d8; SA can cast *slow* on any opponent within 10' once every other round; SD +2 or better weapon to hit, *rock to mud* slows a stone golem for 2d6 rounds, *mud to rock* heals the golem for all lost hit points, a *flesh to stone* spell makes the golem susceptible to normal weapons for the following round; MR nil; SZ L; ML 20.

Guardian Demon Greater, Yugoloth: INT 14; AL NE; AC -1; MV 9, FI 9 (D); HD 10; hp 80; THACO 10; #AT 3; Dmg 1d10/1d12/1d12; SA breath fire three times per day in a cone 30' long with a 10' base diameter for 7d6, a successful saving throw versus breath weapon reduces damage by half, can make a suggestion as the spell, once per round even when in combat; SD immune to charm, hold, sleep, polymorph, and fear spells, immune to magical fire, normal fire, and normal missiles, half damage from electrical attacks; MR 25%; SZ L; ML 18.

The treasure on the dais is a collection of gold and platinum statuary, religious ornaments and decorations worth about 5,516 gp, and 285 miscellaneous cut gems (40 x 3 gp, 45 x 7 gp, 100 x 9 gp, 25 x 30 gp, 75 x 50 gp).

Several magical items are found within the pile of coins. The first is an ivory statue of a large lizard that is a *wand of curing* with eight charges. There is also a suit of *chain mail* +2, a *long bow* +2, a *horn of fog*, three *candles of invocation*, a *robe of scintillating colors* and three vials of *Keoghtom's ointment*.

A flat octagonal coffer of ornately carved ivory is buried at the bottom of the pile of treasure. The coffer has a clasp and hinges of electrum and its cover is worked in a stylized relief design of waves, clouds, trees, and seabirds, with a lanteen-rigged ship visible far off in the waves. The coffer is worth 650 gp total and is locked but untrapped. Inside is the burnt remnant of a great tome. All that survives is a front cover of black dragon hide stretched over a sheet of slate stitched with wire and five scorched fire-browned pages. The tome is what is left of The Glandar's Grimoire.³⁵

The XP from this adventure is 116,015.

¹ The North, Guide to the Savage Frontier, (boxed set), The Wilderness, pg. 54-55, The Savage Frontier FR5 (original), pg. 52, 54, and 63

² The Savage Frontier FR5 (original), pg. 63.

³ Original magical item

⁴ The Book of Artifacts, Dragon Tree Press, pg. 11.

⁵ Forgotten Realms DMs Sourcebook, (original boxed set) pg. 91-92 and Pages from the Mages, pg. 113-114.

⁶ Original magical item.

⁷ The Book of Artifacts, Dragon Tree Press, pg. 9.

⁸ The Savage Frontier FR5 (original), pg. 7.

⁹ Original magical item.

¹⁰ Dragon Magazine #167, March 1991, "Arcane Lore", pg. 36.

¹¹ The Savage Frontier FR5 (original), pg. 62.

¹² Dragon Magazine #164, December 1990, "Arcane Lore" pg. 58, and Pages from the Mages, pgs. 18-19.

¹³ The Savage Frontier, FR5 (original), pg. 7.

¹⁴ The North, Guide to the Savage Frontier, (boxed set), The Wilderness, pg. 15-19, and The Savage Frontier, FR5 (original) pgs. 10, and 20-25.

¹⁵ The North, Guide to the Savage Frontier, (boxed set), The Wilderness, pg. 31 and 54, and The Savage Frontier FR5 (original) pg. 23-24, 41, 59, and 63. Modified to reflect my campaign.

¹⁶ AKA Nighthelm; The Magister, pg. 44, has 96 charges left in the great black sapphire at the start of the battle, and has nine of the opals left on the lower edge.

¹⁷ Unearthed Arcana, pg. 93.

¹⁸ The Book of Artifacts, Dragon Tree Press, pg. 18.

¹⁹ DMG, pg. 150.

²⁰ The Magister, pg. 49, has 11 charges left, command word "Ailun" originally stolen from Azoun II's treasury; any PC having this wand and displaying its powers in public are likely to get a visit from the Purple Dragons with a "request" for the adventurers to present themselves in Azoun IV's court with an explanation of how they came to possess stolen city property.

²¹ Original magical item; given to the annis by Grinthalke the demon in Hellgate Keep, has seven diamonds. Diamonds 1-4 each hold a single type one demon, stones 5-7 each hold a type two demon.

²² The North, Guide to the Savage Frontier, The Wilderness, pg. 55; adventurers arrive in the basement of the ruined temple of Corellon Larethian which is unfortunately also occupied by the mature adult green dragon named Chloracridara who violently protects her two eggs and considerable hoard. They appear on an identical stone dais

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that if they remain upon for a melee round, they will be *teleported without error* back to the Hall of Mists.

²³ Riddle Rooms #1, Dungeon Dilemmas, Cloud Kingdom Games, cover.

²⁴ DMG pg. 161.

²⁵ The Savage Frontier (original) FR5, pg. 7.

²⁶ Riddle Rooms #1, Dungeon Dilemmas, Cloud Kingdom Games, back page.

²⁷ A unique snake based upon the entry in the Monster Manual pg. 88.

²⁸ The North, (boxed set), Guide to the Savage Frontier, The Wilderness, pgs. 8, 62, and 81.

²⁹ Own spell.

³⁰ Dragon Magazine #203 March 1994, pg. 36.

³¹ Hall of the High King, TSR pg. 51.

³² Dragon Magazine #185 September 1992, pg. 62.

³³ DMG pg. 163, size is 9' long by 6' wide; capacity of four people, with a movement rate of 24.

³⁴ Dungeon Magazine November/December 1989 #20.

³⁵ Dragon Magazine #164, December 1990 pgs. 60-61 and Pages from the Mages pgs. 59-60.